Nico Smith

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PROFLE

Mathematics graduate from the University of Cambridge (Rank 8th/256) currently studying for a Master's. Strong mathematical and analytical problem-solving skills, supported by proficient Python programming. Experience in quantitative finance and academic research, including research on Transformers and nonparametric regression. Seeking a mathematically stimulating career with collaborative and research aspects, and currently actively pursuing AI safety pathways.

EDUCATION

Pembroke College, University of Cambridge - Mathematics BA, Mathematics MMATH (current studies) Oct 2023-Present | First Class - Ranked 8th/256

King's College London Maths School - A-levels | Sep 2021-July 2023 | A*A*A* Mathematics, Further Mathematics, Physics, AS A in Computer Science

The Latymer School - GCSEs | Sep 2016-July 2021 | 10 GCSEs, including Triple Science, German, Russian, Design & Technology, all 9s

Rokesly Primary School - A* Mathematics GCSE | June 2016

WORK EXPERIENCE

Da Vinci - Quant Trader Intern | July-August 2026

Focused on options theory, US options market sim trading, and worked on a project applying gradient boosted trees to crypto markets. Received a full-time return offer.

Cambridge Statslab - SRIM Project Researcher | July-August 2025

Researched the in-context regression capabilities of Transformers. Found that Transformers can perform minimax-optimal nonparametric regression with many fewer parameters than previously established, resulting in co-authorship of the paper mentioned in Achievements.

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Satish Kumar Aggarwal Prize, Powell Prize, Legg Prize, all from Pembroke College for outstanding performance in Mathematics.
- Co-authored a paper 'Efficient and Minimax Optimal In-context Nonparametric Regression with Transformers' in the Cambridge Statslab, presented at ICML, arXiv 2601.15014.
- Peter May prize for Tripos performance while participating in University Sports (Cricket Blue).
- British Informatics Olympiad competitor.
- Attended PROMYS Europe, a rigorous, competitive Europe-wide mathematical summer camp, focused on number theory.
- Achieved a top 50 finish in British Physics Olympiad.
- Epistemic Award for Further Mathematics from KCLMS for exceptional attainment.

SKILLS

- ***Python:*** *Proficient with good experience, including LLM-assisted coding best practices.*